

# Creative Inspire T7700

Seven for the big blow

The Creative T7700 is the first 7.1 speaker set, and the only one to take part in this comparison. It comprises seven satellites and one wooden sub-woofer for a deep punchy bass. The front three satellites are two-way speakers, with a tweeter and a separate mid-range, whereas the rest make do with just a full-range speaker. A sleek wired remote control featuring bass, master volume/on-off controls, a line-in and a headphone jack is provided. Apart from these, a new connector, M-port, which allows you to connect a Creative MP3 player such as MuVo-NX, etc, to the speakers directly, also makes its way on this cute remote.

To test these speakers, we used the Creative SoundBlaster Audigy 2 ZS Platinum Pro since it offers a 7.1 output jack. An extensive setup guide helps you get the set up without any fuss. The rear and side satellites have cables long enough to be placed according to your listening preferences.

The performance was a mixed result. The highs and mid-frequencies were reproduced excellently. However, at 24W RMS, the sub-woofer lacks depth and punch. Bass was clean and undistorted, as long as the volume knob did not cross the 70 per cent mark. Thereafter, distortions were clearly heard.

In the game tests, the speakers reproduced excellent



sound in *AquaMark 3*, but *Quake III* sounded rather dull. The effects are sure to make you jump out of your skin on a quiet, silent night!

Results in the music tests ranged from average to good. Sound reproduction is good, but becomes sharper at high volumes, indicating the tweeters going overboard. It's a pleasure to watch a DVD movie—the sound just wraps you like an envelope, but only if the speaker placement is properly planned.

Priced at Rs 11,900, the Inspire T7700 is reasonably priced. However, you need a 7.1 capable card to exploit its full potential. We recommend this speaker set to those who like watching DVDs with full effects and aren't bothered by the lack of a thundering bass. If you are a gamer or a music lover though, give this set a miss.

Though there are seven speakers in total, they do not have impressive sound quality. They do not create surround sound at all; They sound muffled at certain low frequencies. There are better sounding speakers in 4.1 and 5.1, why do I need 7.1?

— NISSAR ALI CHIKATE

**Price:** Rs 11,900  
+ Good build quality  
- Subwoofer lacks punch, effects not reproduced properly

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|---------------------------------|----------|
| Performance                     | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features                        | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Build quality                   | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money                 | ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ |

## Wired for Sound

You've just received your dream system—for which you scrounged and scrimped every single *naya paisa*—and you're on cloud nine. However, as you open the box, your ecstasy quickly dies away, as all you can see besides the speakers is a large bunch of wires with pins at their ends, and a bunch of tiny holes to stick them into. What goes where?

**Analog cables:** These connectors are the most common interconnect links, primarily used to carry analogue audio signals. They connect low-end soundcards, as well as televisions, VCRs and CD players to the speakers. At times, one end of an analog cable sports an RCA connector that's generally smaller than the standard analog connector. This may occur in a powered sub-woofer.



**Coaxial cables:** Coaxial cables are a combination of two cables—one running through the centre of the other—separated by a non-conducting jacket. Coaxial signals carry digital signals very efficiently, and hence, are used in the newer 5.1 and above sound cards. All coaxial cables feature an F-connector at one end. Similar to a cable-TV connector, it is usually linked in tandem with a DIN connector.

**Optical cables:** This is the latest type of connector, and utilises fibre-optic technology to transmit audio signals. Though very thin, these cables are very efficient in carrying digital audio signals. These are commonly used to connect DVD players, and game consoles.

